Stephan Hobler

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Education

London School of Economics and Political Science 2020–present
P.hD. in Economics

University of Oxford (Distinction) 2018–2020
MPhil in Economics

University of Warwick 2015–2018
BSc in Economics

References

Professor Wouter den Haan
Department of Economics
London School of Economics
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Professor Matthias Doepke
Department of Economics
London School of Economics
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Professor Jonathon Hazell
Department of Economics
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Professor Maarten De Ridder
Department of Economics
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Job Market Paper

Worker Mobility and the Diffusion of Radical Technologies.

Abstract. *This paper studies how worker mobility and labor market institutions shape the diffusion of radical technologies through knowledge spillovers. I propose a theory with two-sided heterogeneity in which firms and workers accumulate technology-specific know-how through mutual learning, and worker mobility is subject to search frictions. When existing knowledge is only partially transferable to new technologies, the reallocation of experienced workers becomes central to their diffusion. I calibrate the model to U.S. labor markets in the context of a particular technology — predictive AI — to match empirical patterns using comprehensive microdata from LinkedIn. I then analyze the transition dynamics of introducing a radical new technology. Initially, scarcity of expertise forces firms to adopt internally using inexperienced workers. As diffusion progresses, the constraint on experienced labor relaxes, accelerating adoption through the reallocation of workers, and generating an S-shaped diffusion curve. Aggregate output follows a J-curve pattern, with growth remaining sluggish initially before accelerating as productivity gains materialize. Poaching accounts for up to 60% of adoption, with its contribution peaking during the acceleration phase. A counterfactual exercise re-calibrated to European-style labor markets yields modestly higher steady-state output relative to the U.S., but reduces the welfare gain from the radical new technology by one third.*

Publications

Multi-Layered Rational Inattention and Time-Varying Volatility. *Journal of Economic Dynamics and Control*, Vol. 139, 2022.

Working Papers

Do Deficits Cause Inflation? A High Frequency Narrative Approach., with Jonathon Hazell

Why did we think wages are rigid for all those years?, with Thijs van Rens and See Yu Chan

A front fixing approach to solving sovereign default models. Computational Note.

Work in Progress

Granular Search in the Product Market.

Intangible capital, leverage dynamics, and economic growth., with Johannes Matt

Teaching

Course Manager – EC2B1 Macroeconomics II, LSE	2023–2025
Teaching Assistant – EC2B1 Macroeconomics II, LSE	2022–2023
Teaching Assistant – EC210 Macroeconomic Principles, LSE	2021–2022
Teaching Assistant – Tools for Macroeconomists: Advanced Tools (Summer School)	2023,2024

Other Professional Experience

Research Assistant to Prof. Maarten De Ridder, LSE	2024
Research Assistant to Prof. Joe Hazell, LSE	2021–2023
Research Assistant to Prof. Martin Ellison, University of Oxford	2020
Research Assistant to Prof. Thijs van Rens, University of Warwick	2017–2018

Awards & Grants

STICERD Grant 2024, LSE
Sir John Hicks Prize for outstanding doctoral student research, LSE
LSE Economics Department Scholarship
NOE TOP Stipendium
Examiner's Prize for Outstanding Performance in Economics for Third Year, University of Warwick
Oliver Hart Prize for Excellent Performance for Second Year, University of Warwick

Refereeing

American Economic Review, *American Economic Review: Insights*, *Economica*

Other Skills

Technical: Julia, Python, Matlab, R
Languages: German (native), English (fluent)